Bow Valley College

Course Outline

VOAS1601

Administrative Skills for the Veterinary Office
Fall 2020 - Spring 2021

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VOAS1601 Administrative Skills for the Veterinary Office

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Learners explore the role and responsibilities of the Veterinary Office Assistant (VOA). The focus is on developing verbal and written communication, reception management, client care, and administrative skills. Additionally, learners examine the role of the VOA in scheduling and supporting clients during euthanasia appointments.

REQUISITES	Complete the following courses: • HUCL1201 - Introduction to Health Care Fundamentals (3)
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	3
HOURS	45
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Describe the administrative role and responsibilities of a VOA when working as receptionist	Communication (1), Thinking Skills (2)
2	Explain the attributes of a VOA and how they enhance client care	Communication (1), Thinking Skills (2)
3	Adapt communication styles to manage organizational situations	Communication (1), Working with Others (4)
4	Prioritize tasks to schedule and modify appointments based on need	Thinking Skills (2)
5	Demonstrate administrative skills required to carry out office procedures	Communication (1)

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	MODULE 1 THE ROLE OF THE VOA AS RECEPTIONIST
Week 2	MODULE 1 THE ROLE OF THE VOA AS RECEPTIONIST
Week 3	MODULE 2 CLIENT EDUCATION
Week 4	MODULE 3 TELEPHONE RECEPTION
Week 5	MODULE 3 TELEPHONE RECEPTION
Week 6	MODULE 3 TELEPHONE RECEPTION
Week 7	MODULE 4 APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING
Week 8	MODULE 4 APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING
Week 9	READING WEEK
Week 10	MODULE 5 THE EUTHANASIA APPOINTMENT
Week 11	MODULE 5 THE EUTHANASIA APPOINTMENT
Week 12	MODULE 6 BASIC RECORDS MANAGEMENT
Week 13	MODULE 7 INVENTORY MANAGEMENT
Week 14	MODULE 8 PROCESSING MAIL IN THE VETERINARY OFFICE
Week 15	FINAL EXAM WEEK

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1, 2, 3, 4	TESTS	15%
1-5	IN-CLASS ASSESSMENTS	20%
1-5	ASSIGNMENTS	40%
1-5	FINAL PROJECT	25%

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	**Percentage**	**Grade Point**	**Description**
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered

C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Prendergast, H. *Front office management for the Veterinary team* (3rd ed.). Elsevier Canada. ISBN: 99780323570404

John Corsan & A. Mackay. *The Veterinary receptionist: Essential skills for client care* (2nd ed.). Elsevier. ISBN: 9780702029288

Sirois, M. (2021). *Elsevier's Veterinary assisting textbook* (3rd ed.). St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Canada.

ISBN: 978-0323681452

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Honesty (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.